

Industry News

Prices of LED products may go up

Prices of all LED products may shoot up this year due to the heavy demand for LEDs worldwide. Global supply of LEDs is facing an acute shortage this year, and this could put pressure on prices.

According to iSuppli, global demand for LEDs has outstripped supply. Total consumption of LEDs rose 10.5 per cent from 57 billion units in 2008 to 63 billion in 2009. Overall LED consumption last year came close to the industry's total capacity of 75 billion units, indicating that many LED manufacturers were operating at nearly 100 per cent utilisation. The demand is supposed to jump by another 20 billion units to top 100 billion in 2011.

The LED market growth is expected to rise by double-digit percentages for at least the next three years, including 2010. Though lots of gadgets use LEDs, LED-backlit LCDs in televisions and laptops are the ones that are really driving the demand up.

Mobile broadband users to equal 2G's

According to Swedish telecom equipment vendor Ericsson, within the next five years, the global mobile broadband use would equal the levels of second-generation mobile phone services (voice and text messaging) today. Nearly 3.5 billion people globally use 2G services today, while the number of those using third-generation (3G) mobile broadband services through their phones or laptops stands at about 400 million.

Ericsson predicts that by 2020, the total number of mobile phone subscriptions globally would touch the six billion mark.

Mitra takes charge as ISA chairman

Dr Biswadip (Bobby) Mitra, president and managing director, Texas Instruments India, has been elected as the new chairman of India Semiconductor Association (ISA) for the year 2010-11. Widely acknowledged for his leadership in the industry, Dr Mitra takes charge at a time when ISA is poised to play a key role in driving rapid growth of the Indian electronics industry.

Bharti Airtel appoints president

Bharti Airtel, an integrated telecom service provider, has appointed Drew Kelton as president-enterprise services, India and South Asia. As president of the enterprise services unit, Kelton's key focus would be to lead transformation of the business to create a world-class business-to-business (B2B) organisation. He will report to Sanjay Kapoor, CEO (India and South Asia), Bharti Airtel.

Worldwide mobile gaming revenue to grow

Worldwide mobile gaming end-user revenue will surpass \$5.6 billion in 2010—a 19 per cent increase from 2009 revenue of \$4.7 billion. According to Gartner, the market will continue to see steady growth through 2014, when it is projected to reach \$11.4 billion.

"The hype around mobile applications stores has opened this market up to numerous publishers and developers—further expanding revenue potential and competition in this industry," said Tuong Nguyen, principal research analyst at Gartner. "Although we expect most mobile gamers to continue to gravitate toward 'free' games, we do not expect the ad-supported

Toshiba India appoints director for PC division

Toshiba India has appointed Tengguo Wu as director of its PC Division. Wu has been instrumental in developing new businesses and markets for Toshiba Corporation across 30 countries including South & Southeast Asia, Middle East, South Africa and Pacific Islands. He has managed diverse portfolios across sales, marketing and general management.

Hitachi appoints new directors

Hitachi Data Systems, a wholly owned subsidiary of Hitachi, has appointed Srikanth Chakrapani as director, channels and strategic alliances for India. Chakrapani will be responsible for executing Hitachi's channel partner programme and driving the technology alliances and sales strategies through the channel organisation consisting of systems integrators, value-added resellers and distributors. In his previous role, he was the regional sales director for west India.

The company has also appointed Rajesh Itagi as director of services sales for India.

model to take off within the next three years—despite the success we have seen with this approach in the Japanese market."

Gartner estimates that 70-80 per cent of all mobile consumer applications downloaded are mobile games. Moreover, 60-70 per cent of these downloaded games are 'free.' This trend is expected to continue for the next two to three years.

Videophones to be the next 'big' thing!

With the advent of 3G and 4G technologies, sales of videophone devices are expected to explode within the next two years. One example is that of ACN Inc. of Concord, N.C., which